



Municipal Unit Strategic Taskforce (MUST) Meeting - September 29th, 2026

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=OnK-kXzP1uQ
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Target Category	delaware_county

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Municipal Committee Meeting Summary Report

Meeting Date: September 29, 2023

Body: Delaware County Municipal Uniformity Study Team (MUST) Committee

2. Meeting Identification & Attendance 00:03:58

- **Call to Order:** Presiding officer Matt Canz called the September 29th municipal committee meeting to order at **00:03:58**, noting the date and the committee name.
- **Attendance:**
 - **Present:** Matt Canz (Delaware County Council / Presiding Officer), Matt Waggle (City of Muncie), Lance Turner (Yorktown), Bridget Duiz (Eaton), Jennifer Divine (Selma), Tracy Pittinger (Gaston), Amy Roberts (Daleville).
 - **Absent:** Deborah Dunham (Chesterfield <U+2014> noted prior that she could not attend).

3. Preliminary & Procedural Business 00:04:03

- **Ceremonial Openings:** The committee stood for the recitation of the Pledge of Allegiance led by the presiding officer 00:04:14.
 - **Approval of Minutes:** *Not mentioned in the transcript.*
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4. Substantive Business & Board Action 00:05:28

00:05:28 Presentation and Review of Revised Local Income Tax (LIT) Distribution Model

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Matt Canz (Presiding Officer) introducing Sam and Jason from Policy Analytics.
- **Deliberation Summary:**
 - Policy Analytics presented a revised Local Income Tax (LIT) distribution model developed in response to feedback from the September 1 meeting.
 - **Core Goals:** (1) Revenue neutrality for each taxing unit while balancing shortfalls and windfalls; (2) Rate neutrality keeping the modeled rate at or below the current certified LIT rate of 1.5%.
 - **Key Assumptions:** Muncie and Yorktown would opt into the county-authorized municipal rates (no municipality imposing its own separate rate, meaning 100% of county-authorized municipal revenues go to cities/towns via uniform countywide rates); fire/EMS allocation modeled at 90% to Muncie and 10% to county fire services (Muncie and Yorktown).
 - **Revised Model Adjustments:** To assist smaller municipalities showing revenue shortfalls and mitigate large windfalls, the fire/EMS rate was reduced from 0.40 to 0.22, and the county-authorized municipal LIT rate was increased from 0.35 to 0.45.
 - **Overall Rate:** The total proposed county rate under the revised model decreased to **1.31%** (comprising 0.50 county services, 0.22 fire/EMS, 0.14 non-municipal, and 0.45 county-authorized municipal rate), leaving roughly 20 cents of unused rate capacity beneath the 1.5% cap (representing about \$6 million).
 - It was emphasized that the committee's vote is non-binding and serves as a report to the state legislature, which retains ultimate authority and is expected to revisit the statutes.
- **Item-Specific Public Input:**
 - **Sears Perry (Town of Yorktown) 00:04:50:** Inquired how the 1.31% rate was determined and confirmed statutory maximums vs. local goals.
 - **Chief Dan Ber (Muncie Fire Department) 00:32:40:** Raised concerns regarding township fire protection funding shortfalls (specifically Center Township Trustee) and mutual aid impacts.

- **Tom Roberts (Town Board of Daleville) 00:36:35:** Questioned whether CY2026 distribution figures fully incorporated prior Economic Development Income Tax (EDIT) distributions.
 - **Stephen Brand (Delaware County Commissioner) 00:47:01:** Discussed the absorption of EDIT funds into the new LIT structure, current county debt encumbrances on EDIT, and recommended that county commissioners continue managing EDIT allocations.
 - **Rick Genser (Newsman/Author) 00:46:16:** Cautioned against using EDIT for operations/debt and suggested exploring fire territories.
 - **Lance Turner (Yorktown) 00:53:35:** Inquired about timelines for official opt-in/opt-out decisions.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:**
 - A roll call vote was conducted regarding consensus on the 1.31% rate structure:
 - **Amy Roberts (Daleville):** Yes
 - **Tracy Pittinger (Gaston):** Yes
 - **Jennifer Divine (Selma):** Yes
 - **Bridget Duiz (Eaton):** Yes (with reservations)
 - **Lance Turner (Yorktown):** Abstain
 - **Matt Waggley (City of Muncie):** Yes
 - **Matt Canz (Delaware County Council):** Yes
 - **Disposition:** Approved by Majority Voice/Roll Call Consensus (with 1 abstention and reservations noted) to formalize and submit into the state report.
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5. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

- *Note: Public input occurred organically during the substantive agenda item discussion rather than a standalone concluding forum.* Key contributors included local officials and residents Sears Perry, Chief Dan Ber, Tom Roberts, Stephen Brand, Rick Genser, and Lance Turner (summarized in Section 4).
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6. Administrative Updates & Adjournment 00:57:00

- **Staff / Board Announcements:**
 - The statutory distribution report is due to the state by November 2nd (00:51:59). Matt Canz stated he will compile the report, incorporating discussion summaries, and circulate it to committee members for review prior to submission.
 - **Adjournment:**
 - With no further business, the meeting was officially **adjourned** by presiding officer Matt Canz 00:58:47.
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